

Changing weather

The world's weather has changed many times. About 10,000 years ago, great sheets of ice covered a third of the Earth. That was the last Ice Age. Today we live in a much warmer climate. Many scientists think we have harmed the atmosphere so much that the world is getting even warmer.

Prehistoric weather

Millions of years ago, when dinosaurs roamed the land, much of Europe and North America was covered in forests. The climate was hotter and more humid than it is today.



Sun trap

Only a small portion of the Sun's heat reaches the Earth. But the Earth stays warm because gases, such as carbon dioxide, trap the heat—just like the glass in a greenhouse. Carbon dioxide is a greenhouse gas that is made when we burn wood, coal, or oil. If we produce too much, the Earth may get too warm.

The gases in the atmosphere trap some heat, which keeps the world nice and warm.

Some heat is reflected back into space.

